



JPK

**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
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ARAS 7 & 8 BLOK D4, KOMPLEK D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN
PERSEKUTUAN
62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN
(INFORMATION SHEET)

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TAHAP / LEVEL	3 (THREE)	
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NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN / <i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>	03.01. LIAISE COMMUNICATION PRACTICE 03.02. APPLY BASIC NEGOTIATION SKILLS	
NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015-M01/P(1/2)	Mukasurat / Page : 1 Drpd / of : 16

TAJUK/TITLE: COMMUNICATION LIAISON PRACTICE

TUJUAN/PURPOSE:

This Information Sheet is intended to describe about Communication Liaison_Practice that comprises knowledge of difference types of information input such as text, graphics, statistical data, web information, pictorial information and type of languages that encompass spoken and sign. It also explains about skills required for communication liaison practice when working closely with somebody and the exchange of information with him or her. The person who is competent in this CA shall be able to liaise information sharing to achieve objectives.

PENERANGAN/INFORMATION:**1. What is Effective Communication?**

1.1 Effective communication is defined as verbal speech or other methods of relaying information that is easily understood by the receiving party and gets the point across. An example of effective communication is when you talk or convey the information in clear and simple terms.

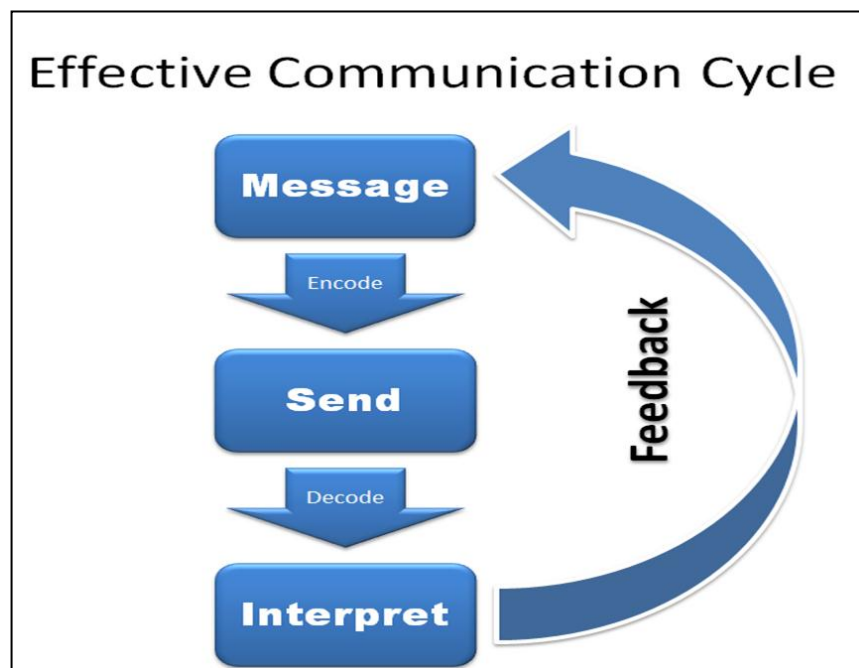


Figure 1: The Effective Communication Cycle

1.2 There are two types of communications which are **Horizontal communication / Lateral communication** and **vertical communication**.

1.3 **Horizontal communication** involves the flow of messages between individuals and groups on the same level of an organization. Its can produce a higher quality of information exchange since it occurs directly between people working in the same environment.

1.4 Communication within a team is an example of horizontal communication; members coordinate tasks, work together, and resolve conflicts. Horizontal

NO. KOD ICODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015 M01/P(1/2)	Mukasurat/ Page : 3 Drpd. / of: 16
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communication occurs formally in meetings, presentations, and formal electronic communication, and informally, within the office. Horizontal communication problems can occur because of territoriality, rivalry, specialization, and simple lack of motivation.

1.5 Territoriality occurs when members of an organization regard other people's involvement in their area as an inappropriate or unwelcome.

1.6 Rivalry between individuals or teams can lead to reluctance to cooperate and to share information.

1.7 Specialization is a problem that occurs when there is a lack of uniform knowledge or vocabulary within or between departments.

1.8 **Vertical Communication** is the of the communication that takes place within an organization which involves chain of command from the executive office to the front lines. It follows a top – down, bottom-up or hierarchic communication and involves the spreading of messages from individuals across the base of a pyramid.

1.9 Rules and mandates come down from the top leadership to management and trickle down to the front-line supervisors, eventually reaching the workers. When workers have an issue, they usually talk first to their immediate supervisor. The chain of command dictates that supervisors report the issue to their managers, who then are responsible to carry the information up to the executive offices.

1.10 The main purpose of operating with a vertical communication system is to control the flow of information and decision-making. Top-down communication usually consists of orders, mandates, policy decisions, directions and instructions. The policies and goals of the organization typically come from the top and move down through the chain of command. Communication that flows upward typically involves information from the front lines to the executives about what's going on at the lower levels. It might include complaints, suggestions, reports, requests for clarification or news about trends.

NO. KOD ICODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015 M01/P(1/2)	Mukasurat/ Page : 4 Drpd. / of: 16
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1.11 However, as the information is often filtered as it moves up and down the chain of command, managers who receives the information may decide the validity/importance of the information and slow its motion or stop it altogether. Information meant for distribution down to all the lower levels may become stalled. Middle management may decide their workers don't need the information and halt its progress. Information going in either direction may change or become diluted if not passed up or down in its original form. This can be a bad thing if the judgement of value of the information properly handled.

1.12 Various channels used to send information up and down the chain of command also affect the ways it's perceived and acted upon. When passed on verbally, information is tainted by body language, spoken nuances and personalities of the informant. The person receiving the information brings various filters to every conversation that can change the intention of the information.

1.13 Written communication, on the other hand, when passed on unchanged, may effectively send a consistent message through an organizational structure.

1.14 Electronic communication can be more easily manipulated. Organizations may utilize a wide range of applications to get and receive pertinent information.

2. What is information?

2.1 Information is data that is accurate and timely, specific and organized for a purpose, presented within a context that gives it meaning and relevance, and can lead to an increase in understanding and decrease in uncertainty. Information is valuable because it can affect behaviour, a decision, or an outcome. A piece of information is considered valueless if, after receiving it, things remain unchanged. Information sometimes defined as an assortment of definitions quoted from 'expert sources' such as:

- i) Information is the act of telling or imparting knowledge.
- ii) Information is knowledge acquired from another.

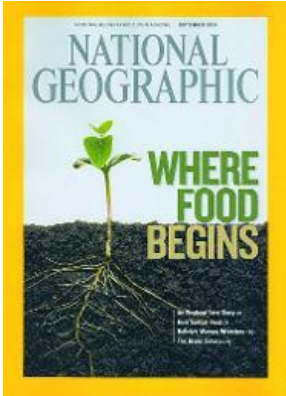
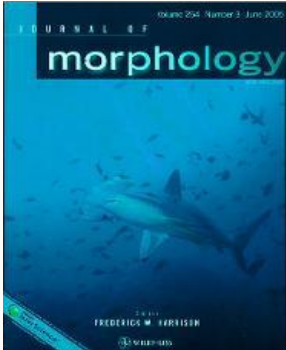
NO. KOD ICODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015 M01/P(1/2)	Mukasurat/ Page : 5 Drpd. / of: 16
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- iii) Information is knowledge you can convey to others.
- iv) Information is facts communicated or learned.
- v) Information is data interpreted to be useful.
- vi) Information is facts and figures.
- vii) Information is the 'lifeblood of 21st century society'.
- viii) Information is power.

2.2 Source of Information can come from virtually anywhere — media, blogs, personal experiences, books, journal and magazine articles, expert opinions, encyclopaedias', and web pages such as text, graphics, statistical data, web information and pictorial information. The type of information will change depending on the question. Different sorts of questions require different types of information to answer. Information categories listed below will give useful framework for thinking about the information needs:

- i) News (what's the latest on X? What is happening about Y?)
- ii) Ideas and opinions (what do people think about X?)
- iii) Research results (what does the latest research tell us about X?)
- iv) Theoretical analysis/theory (what are the different theoretical perspectives on Y?)
- v) Everyday practicalities (e.g. Train timetables, telephone numbers, maps)
- vi) Facts and figures (how many cases of X were there last year?)
- vii) History or background (when did X start? What happened?)
- viii) People's experience (what is it like to suffer from X? Or to use y service?)
- ix) Advice or help (can anyone help me with my work on Y?)
- x) Technical information (how to mend Z)
- xi) Legal information

2.3 In order to gather evidence to support an argument, an idea of what types of information are suitable and which types of information appropriate for the project can be gained by answering the questions.

Type	Information	Use	Examples
 Magazine	A magazine is a collection of articles and images about diverse topics of popular interest and current events. Usually these articles are written by journalists or scholars and are geared toward the average adult. Magazines may cover very "serious" material, but to find consistent scholarly information, you should use journals.	• To find information or opinions about popular culture • To find up-to-date information about current events • To find general articles for people who are not necessarily specialists about the topic	• <i>National Geographic</i> • <i>Ebony</i> • <i>Sports Illustrated</i> • <i>People</i>
 Academic journal	A journal is a collection of articles usually written by scholars in an academic or professional field. An editorial board reviews articles to decide whether they should be accepted. Articles in journals can cover very specific topics or narrow fields of research.	• When doing scholarly research to find out what has been studied on your topic • To find bibliographies that point to other relevant research	• Journal of Communication • The Historian • Journal of the American Medical Association • Lancet
 Newspapers	A newspaper is a collection of articles about current events usually published daily. Since there is at least one in every city, it is a great source for local information.	• To find current information about international, national and local events • To find editorials, commentaries, expert or popular opinions	• <i>Roanoke Times</i> • <i>New York Times</i> • <i>Suddeutsche Zeitung</i>



Database

A database contains citations of articles in magazines, journals, and newspapers. They may also contain citations to podcasts, blogs, videos, and other media types. Some databases contain abstracts or brief summaries of the articles, while other databases contain complete, full-text articles.

- When you want to find articles on your topic in magazines, journals or newspapers

- Academic Search Complete (a general database)
- Compendex (an engineering database)
- ABI/Inform (a business database)



Addison

A library catalogue is an organized and searchable collection of records of every item in a library and can be found on the library home page. The catalog will point you to the location of a particular source, or group of sources, that the library owns on your topic.

- To find out what items the library owns on your topic
- To find where a specific item is located in the library

Virginia Tech's library catalogue is called Addison.



Books

Books cover virtually any topic, fact or fiction. For research purposes, you will probably be looking for books that synthesize all the information on one topic to support a particular argument or thesis.

Libraries organize and store their book collections on shelves called "stacks."

- When looking for **lots** of information on a topic
- To put your topic in context with other important issues
- To find historical information
- To find summaries of research to support an argument

- Nash, Gary B. ed. *The American People: Creating a Nation and a Society*, 1990.
- Silverstone, Roger, ed. *Visions of Suburbia*, 1997.
- Smith, J. T. *Roman Villas: A Study in Social Structure*, 1997

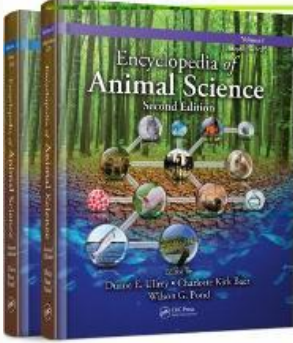
 Encyclopaedia	Encyclopaedias are collections of short, factual entries often written by different contributors who are knowledgeable about the topic. There are two types of encyclopaedias: general and subject. General encyclopaedias provide concise overviews on a wide variety of topics. Subject encyclopaedias contain in-depth entries focusing on one field of study.	• When looking for background information on a topic • When trying to find key ideas, important dates or concepts	• <i>African-American Encyclopedia</i> (subject encyclopedia) • <i>Encyclopedia Americana</i>(general encyclopedia) • <i>World Book</i>(general encyclopedia found online) • <i>Gale encyclopaedia of genetic disorders</i> (subject encyclopaedia found online)
 Web site	The Web allows you to access most types of information on the Internet through a browser. One of the main features of the Web is the ability to quickly link to other related information. The Web contains information beyond plain text, including sounds, images, and video. The important thing to do when using information on the Internet is to know <u>how to evaluate it!</u>	• To find current information • To find information about companies • To find information from all levels of government - federal to local • To find both expert and popular opinions • To find information about hobbies and personal interests	• lcweb.loc.gov (The Library of Congress) • wikipedia.org (a wiki) • www.vt.edu (Virginia Tech)

Figure 1.2: Types of Information Sources

3. What is Language?

3.1 Language is the ability to acquire and use complex systems of communication, particularly the human ability to do so, and a language is any specific example of such a system. The scientific study of language is called linguistics.

NO. KOD ICODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015 M01/P(1/2)	Mukasurat/ Page : 9 Drpd. / of: 16
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3.2 The main purpose of language is to communicate information. However, people commonly use language for:

- i) Communicative functions:
 - a) Survival functions: Meeting your most basic needs
 - b) Social functions: Interacting with other people:
 - functions used when socializing
 - functions used in establishing and maintaining relationships
 - functions involving barriers
 - functions involving influencing people
 - functions involving feedback
 - functions involved in arguing
 - functions involving avoiding trouble
- ii) Self-expressive functions:
 - functions involving expressing opinions
 - functions involving expressing emotions
- iii) Cognitive functions:
 - functions for managing conversations

3.2 Natural type of languages are spoken or signed, but any language can be encoded into secondary media using auditory, visual, or tactile stimuli – for example, in graphic writing, braille, or whistling.

3.3 Spoken language is language produced by articulate sounds, as opposed to written language. Many languages have no written form, and so are only spoken. Oral language or vocal language is language produced with the vocal tract, as opposed to sign language, which is produced with the hands and face. The term "spoken language" is sometimes used to mean only vocal languages, especially by linguists, making all three terms synonyms by excluding sign languages. Others refer to sign language as "spoken", especially in contrast to written transcriptions of signs.

3.4 In spoken language, much of the meaning is determined by the context. This contrasts with written language, where more of the meaning is provided directly by the text. In spoken language the truth of a proposition is determined by common-sense reference to experience, whereas in written language a greater emphasis is placed on logical and coherent argument; similarly, spoken language tends to convey subjective information, including the relationship between the speaker and the audience, whereas written language tends to convey objective information. The relationship between spoken language and written language is complex. Within the field of linguistics the current consensus is that speech is an innate human capability while written language is a cultural invention and possesses distinct qualities which would argue against written language being dependent on spoken language for its existence.

3.5 A sign language is a language which uses manual communication and body language to convey meaning, as opposed to acoustically conveyed sound patterns. This can involve simultaneously combining hand shapes, orientation and movement of the hands, arms or body, and facial expressions to fluidly express a speaker's thoughts. They share many similarities with spoken languages (sometimes called "oral languages", which depend primarily on sound), which is why linguists consider both to be natural languages, but there are also some significant differences between signed and spoken languages. Vocal and sign languages are composed of words. In vocal languages, words are made up from a limited set of vowels and consonants, and often tone; in sign languages, words are made up from a limited set of shapes, orientations, locations, and movements of the hands, and often facial expressions; in both cases, these building blocks are called phonemes. In both vocal and sign languages, words are grammatically and prosaically linked into phrases, clauses, and larger units of discourse.

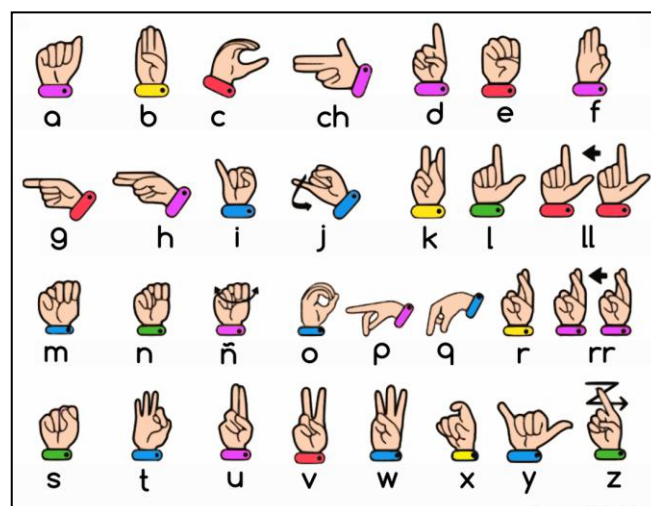


Figure 3.5.(i): Vowels and Consonants of Sign Language

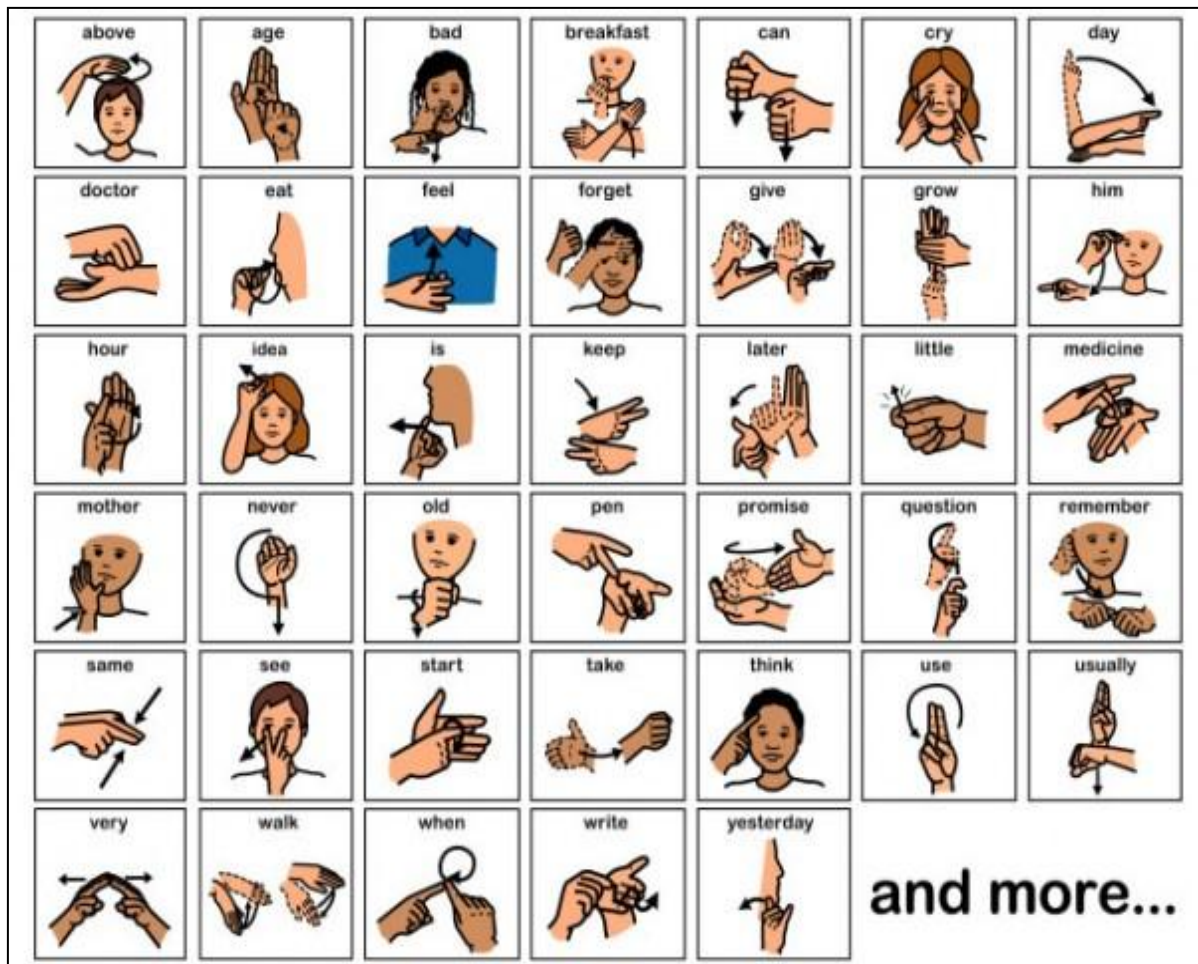


Figure 3.5 (ii): Phonemes of Sign Language

4. How to Liaise Communication Practice?

4.1 No matter your age, background, or experience, effective communication is a skill you can learn. Thus, to communicate effectively a truly efficient communicator need to get the point across. With a little self-confidence and knowledge of the basics, below are rules and procedures need to be followed:

- i) Creating the right environment
- ii) Organizing communications
- iii) Communicating with speech
- iv) Communicating with body language
- v) Communicating effectively in conflict

vi) Conversation

4.2. Creating the Right Environment

- i) Choose the right time. As the cliché states, there is a time and a place for everything, and communicating is no different.
 - a) Avoid starting discussions about heavy topics in the late evening. Few people will be thrilled to be faced with sorting major issues like finances or long range scheduling when they are the most tired. Instead, deliver messages and conduct discussions about heavy topics in the mornings or afternoons when people are alert, available, and more likely to be able to respond with clarity.

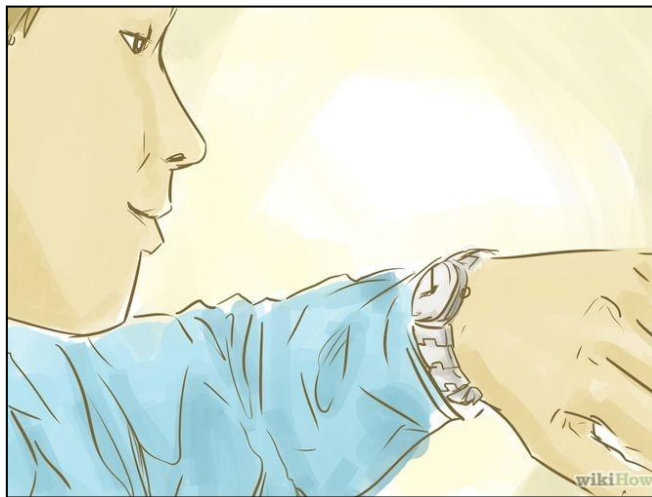


Figure 4.1 : Choose the right time

- ii) Facilitate an open, intimate conversation. Choose the right place, one that provides freedom for the communication to open, flower, and come to maturity. If you need to tell someone something that isn't going to sit well (such as news of a death or a breakup), don't do it in public, around colleagues, or near other people. Be respectful and mindful of the person by communicating to them in a private place. This will also provide space to open the dialog into a wider and a more involved mutual understanding and ensure that the two-way process is functioning properly.
 - a) If you are presenting to a group of people, be sure to check the acoustics beforehand and practice projecting your voice clearly. Use a microphone if needed to ensure that your audience can hear you.

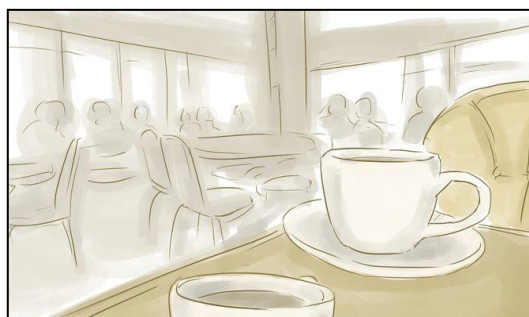


Figure 4.1.a : Facilitate an Open, Intimate Conversation

b) Remove distractions.

Turn off *all* electronics that could interrupt the conversation. If the phone rings, laugh it off the first time, then turn it off immediately and continue talking. Do not allow external distractions to act as crutches that sidetrack your concentration. They will distract both you and your listener, and will effectively kill the communication



Figure 4.1.b : Remove Distractions

4.2 Organizing Your Communications

- i) Organize and clarify ideas in your mind. This should be done before you attempt to communicate any ideas. If you are feeling passionate about a topic, your ideas may become garbled if you haven't already targeted some key points to stick to when communicating. Key points will act as anchors, bringing focus and clarity to your communication.
- ii) A good rule of thumb is to choose three main points and keep your communication focused on those. That way, if the topic wanders off course,

you will be able to return to one or more of these three key points without feeling flustered.

iii) Writing the points down, if appropriate, can also help.

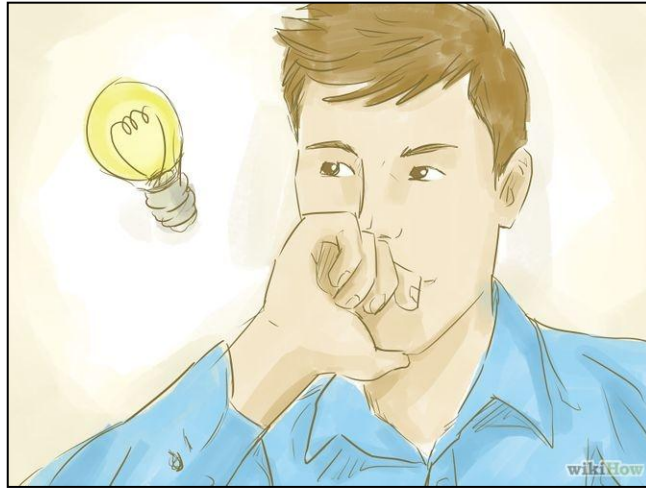


Figure 4.2.a : Organize and Clarify Ideas

iv) Be crystal clear. Make it clear what you're hoping to convey from the outset. For example, your purpose could be to inform others, obtain information, or initiate action. If people know in advance what you expect from the communication, things will go more smoothly.



Figure 4.2.b: Be Crystal Clear

iv) Stay on topic. Once you start to convey your three main points, make sure everything you're saying adds to the message you intend to communicate and strengthens it. If you have already thought through the issues and

distilled the them to the essentials, it is likely that helpful pertinent phrases will stick in your mind. Do not be afraid to use these to underline your points. Even confident, well-known speakers reuse their key lines again and again for emphasis and reinforcement. Remember to keep the overall message clear and direct.



Figure 4.2c: Stay On Topic

- v) **Thank your listener(s).** Thank the person or group for the time taken to listen and respond. No matter what the outcome of your communication, even if the response to your talk or discussion has been other than you had hoped; end it politely by properly respecting everyone's input and time.

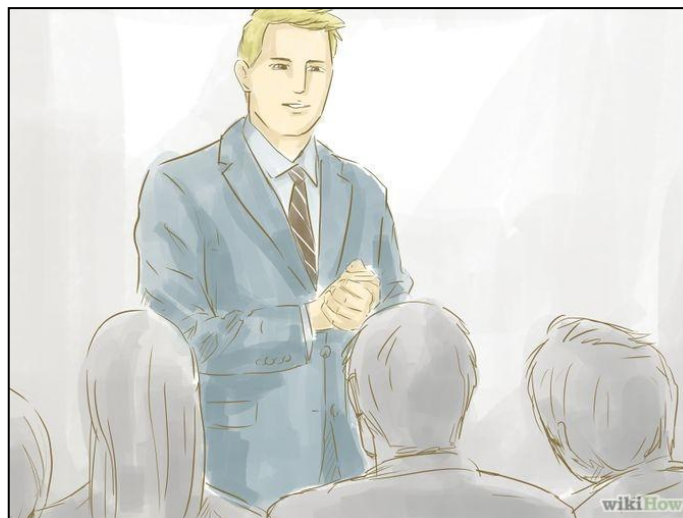


Figure 4.2d: Thank Your Listener

NO. KOD / CODE NO.	Z-009-3:2015 M01/P(1/2)	Mukasurat/ Page : 16 Drpd. / of: 16
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SOALAN/QUESTION:

1. What are the common purposes or functions of language?
2. What do you understand of the differences between spoken and sign language?
3. Explain what is communication liaison practice.
4. Describe best practises of effective communication.

RUJUKAN / REFERENCES:

1. <http://maxcommunicationmotivation.weebly.com/communication-effective-vs-ineffective.html>
2. <http://www.helpguide.org/articles/relationships/effective-communication.htm>
3. <https://www.icre.pitt.edu/mentoring/effective.html>
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5. http://www.open.ac.uk/safari/php_pages/s01t01p010000.php - understanding information
6. <http://www.lib.vt.edu/help/research/info-sources.html> - types of information sources
7. <http://www.01.sil.org/lingualinks/languagelearning/OtherResources/CommnPrpssOrFnctnsOfLngg/contents.html> - Common purposes or functions of language
8. <http://www.wikihow.com/Communicate-Effectively> - How to Communicate Effectively